

****A complete reference for new Costco warehouse employees who want to master the green screen and turn it into a career advantage.****

This booklet documents what is publicly verifiable about Costco's IBM i ("AS400") environment, supplemented with standard IBM i mechanics that apply universally. Confidence is marked throughout: ****[CONFIRMED]**** = directly from Costco employee training artifacts (Quizlet SIT/Optical/Membership flashcards), Costco corporate documents, or Costco job postings; ****[LIKELY]**** = strongly indicated across multiple sources; ****[INFERRED]**** = standard IBM i / retail AS400 behavior that necessarily applies; ****[UNCERTAIN]**** = best-guess scaffolding to verify with a senior supervisor. Costco's IT environment varies by region and is "band-aided to death" in former CFO Richard Galanti's widely-quoted phrase [Source Data](https://source-data.com/2025/08/18/6046/) [X] (https://x.com/BrianRoemmele/status/1927936975732101549?lang=en) — your warehouse may differ in small ways. ****Always check the function-key legend at the bottom of every screen****, because custom Costco screens sometimes rebind defaults.

Section 1 — AS400 fundamentals at Costco

What it actually is

The "green screen" you sign onto at Costco is a ****5250 terminal-emulator session**** running against ****IBM i**** — the modern descendant of IBM's AS/400 (1988) [Source Data](https://source-data.com/2025/08/18/6046/) → iSeries → System i → IBM Power Systems lineage. [Windows Forum] (https://windowsforum.com/threads/costcos-ibm-i-backbone-why-as-400-lineage-still-drives-retail-scale.398807/) Employees still universally call it "the AS400." [CONFIRMED — BGR; Source-Data; Costco iSeries job postings] The OS was once called OS/400; [Windows Forum](https://windowsforum.com/threads/costcos-ibm-i-backbone-why-as-400-lineage-still-drives-retail-scale.398807/) the platform has been continuously updated for 35+ years and runs on current IBM Power hardware, not 1980s tin. [Mastodon] (https://mastodon.social/@nixCraft/111839478303640635)

Costco runs essentially every operational system on this stack: ****merchandising/buying, depot (DC) operations, warehouse applications, transportation, ecommerce integration, and POS****. Active Costco IT job postings out of Issaquah and Dallas seek developers in ****RPGLE, RPG ILE, SQLRPGLE, CL/CLLE, DDS, DB2/400, MQ, Turnover (source control), X-Analysis, ROBOT and UC4 (job schedulers), and iSeries Navigator**** [ZipRecruiter] (https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Jobs/Costco-Wholesale-Iseries-As400) — confirming the depth of the iSeries footprint. [CONFIRMED] Costco simultaneously runs ****SAP, Oracle Hyperion, OneStream, and Google Workspace**** on top of the iSeries data layer, and is in a slow "replatform" [ZipRecruiter] (https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Jobs/Costco-Wholesale-Iseries-As400) initiative [ZipRecruiter] (https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Jobs/Costco-Wholesale-Iseries-As400) — but the green screen will be your primary tool for years to come.

Why Costco keeps it

Three reasons drive Costco's stickiness with IBM i. First, ****reliability**** — the platform delivers ~99.9% uptime [Source Data](https://source-data.com/2025/08/18/6046/) and has never been publicly breached. [Mastodon] (https://mastodon.social/@nixCraft/111839478303640635) [Source Data](https://source-data.com/2025/08/18/6046/) Second, ****fit to model**** — Costco's famously narrow assortment of roughly ****4,000 active SKUs per warehouse**** [Source Data](https://source-data.com/2025/08/18/6046/) (vs. ~30,000 in

a supermarket) [Substack +4](https://ontheseams.substack.com/p/a-brief-primer-on-costcos-distribution) maps cleanly to AS400's batch-oriented strengths. [CONFIRMED] Third, **decades of bespoke RPG code** that encodes Costco's unique processes (cross-dock depots, members, executive memberships, IRCs, the \$1.50 hot dog combo) would be extraordinarily expensive to replicate.

How the environment is structured

You sign on to a customized **Costco main menu** rather than the IBM-standard menu. From the command line at the bottom (`==>`), you type a **3-to-5-letter mnemonic fast-path code** — ``IAI'`, ``IIL'`, ``WII'`, ``EDSR'`, ``MBA'`, ``DASH'` — to launch a screen, instead of drilling through numbered submenus. Within most screens, you put a number in the **Opt** column next to a row to drill in (1 = on-hand by warehouse, [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/)) 3 = sales by region, [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) 5 = display detail, 8 = planned shipments — following the standard IBM i "Work-with" convention). [CONFIRMED]

Behind the curtain, Costco's IBM i runs the standard subsystem split: **QINTER** (your interactive 5250 session), **QBATCH** (overnight POS rollups, replenishment runs, sign-print batches), and **QSPL** (printed signs, receiving manifests, Daily Register Sheet). Cross-warehouse inventory (``IIL'`) **does not refresh in real time** — it updates overnight in QBATCH. [CONFIRMED — Quizlet SIT note: "This information does not update until the following day."] [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) Never promise a member real-time accuracy on a sister-warehouse on-hand.

Logging on and the keyboard

A standard IBM i sign-on screen prompts for **User**, **Password**, and (often pre-filled) **Program/procedure**, **Menu**, and **Current library**. Your manager set up your profile via ``EPRFM'`, which determines exactly which menus and options you see [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) — a cashier, an optical tech, a meat manager, and a buyer all see different doors. **Combo employees** (working multiple departments) get one merged profile; specialty profiles for **Optical**, **Return-To-Vendor (RTV)**, **Sales Audit**, and **Vault** [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) must be explicitly assigned. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) [CONFIRMED]

Once signed on, terminals **auto-secure after 90 seconds of keyboard idle** ("Terminal Secured"). [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/891198106/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/) [CONFIRMED] The status row at the bottom shows indicators like **MW** (Message Waiting), **II** (Input Inhibited — press the Reset key), and **KB** (Keyboard Locked). **Field Exit** (right-Ctrl on a true 5250 keyboard, numpad-Enter in most emulators) is the speed key that blanks the rest of a numeric field and tabs forward — learn it on day one.

Function-key conventions

The standard IBM i layout, which Costco mostly follows: **F1 Help**, **F3 Exit**, **F4 Prompt**, **F5 Refresh**, **F6 Print/Create**, **F9 Retrieve last command**, **F10 Command line**, **F11 Alternate view**, **F12 Cancel**. **Costco-confirmed deviations and additions**: **F8 = Confirm Update** (Buy-Online-Pickup-In-Warehouse ``EOI'` screen), **F9 = Member Pickup** (``EOI'`), [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/723555932/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/) **F21 = Done** (RF-scanner pre-scan option 8). [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) [CONFIRMED] To get F13–F24 on a PC keyboard, hold **Shift** + F1–F12. [Ru-facts](https://ru-facts.com/why-does-costco-use-as400/) [Experts Exchange](https://www.experts-exchange.com/questions/21331786/AS-400-function-keys.html) The **Reset** key (left-Ctrl on a 5250) recovers from the dreaded "X II" input-inhibited state. The **System Request** key (Shift-Esc in most emulators) opens a second interactive job — a power-user trick for running two inquiries side-by-side.

How data flows: buyer → depot → warehouse → POS → reporting

Costco buyers in Issaquah and the eight regional buying offices [Retail MBA](<https://www.retailmba.com/work-with-costco-buyers/>) use **iSeries Merchandising Solutions** (RPGLE/SQLRPGLE) to set up items, vendors, costs, and allocations. Vendors deliver full pallets to one of **~24 regional depots** — pure cross-docks, [Substack](<https://ontheseams.substack.com/p/a-brief-primer-on-costcos-distribution>) [Market Realist](<https://marketrealist.com/2019/12/analyzing-costcos-inventory-supply-chain-management-strategies/>) not storage DCs — where freight is sorted to outbound lanes by warehouse number and shipped same-day. Your warehouse sees inbound trucks via the **`DASH`** dashboard. Stockers "pallet-plug" merchandise straight to the sales-floor rack. [Food Navigator](<https://www.foodnavigator-usa.com/Article/2024/01/30/tips-for-cpg-brands-before-approaching-costco/>) POS transactions update the iSeries DB2/400 database in near-real time, but cross-warehouse on-hand visibility (**`IIL`**) and sales-rank screens (**`IATOP`**, **`MEMR`**) refresh nightly in QBATCH.

Key identifiers you must know cold

Item numbers are **6-to-7-digit numeric codes** [Costco](<https://productsupport.costco.com/customer/articles>) [CONFIRMED — VendorCo and Costco Product Support — note: this is the *correct* range; older summaries citing "5–6 digits" are out of date]. [vendorco](<https://vendorco.com/inside-costco-warehouses-item-numbers/>) The same number is what employees, members, vendors, and signage all use. [vendorco](<https://vendorco.com/inside-costco-warehouses-item-numbers/>) [Vendorco](<https://vendorco.com/inside-costco-warehouses-item-numbers/>) **UPCs** are 12-digit GTIN-12 at consumer-pack level, 14-digit at case/pallet. When manually keying a UPC or an Instant Rebate Coupon code, **drop the last (check) digit** [Quizlet](<https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/>) — a Costco-specific convention. [CONFIRMED]

Warehouse numbers are **3-digit numeric IDs paired with a 2-letter region code** — for example, **129 BA** (Santa Clara, Bay Area), [Costco](<https://www.costco.com/wcsstore/CostcoUSBCCatalogAssetStore/Attachment/french-toast-clothing.pdf>) **388 MW** (Oak Brook, Midwest). [Clubdemo](https://clubdemo.com/wp-content/uploads/2016/05/cds_whs_addresses_05-Whses-by-Region.pdf) Numbers were assigned in opening order and are NOT contiguous; newer warehouses are in the 1000s+ (e.g., #1342, #1661). [Warehouse Runner](<https://app.warehouserunner.com/stores>) Region codes include **BA, NW, LA, SE, SW, NE, MW** and others.

Department numbers anchor every sales/inventory rollup: **11 Tobacco, 12 Candy, 13 Food, 14 Sundries, 16 Liquor, 17 Cooler, 18 Frozen, 19 Deli, 20 HABA, 21 Office, 22 Tires, 23 Hardware, 24 Major Appliances, 25 Auto, 26 Sporting Goods, 27 Garden, 28 Toys/Seasonal**, [Quizlet](<https://quizlet.com/941491638/costco-departments-flash-cards/>) **29 Frozen, 30 Furniture, 31 Kiosk, 32 Bakery**. [CONFIRMED — Quizlet department flashcards] Memorize these — they're keyed into **`DSI`**, **`DSL`**, **`IATOP`**, **`MACR`**, and **`EDSR`** constantly.

Costco lingo not to miss: Warehouse (not "store"). Depot (not "DC"). MPU (Merchandise Pick Up). DRS (Daily Register Sheet). RTV (Return To Vendor). IRC (Instant Rebate Coupon). SIT (Supervisor In Training). Combo employee (multi-department). MOF (Member's Own Frame). [Quizlet](<https://quizlet.com/411667851/costco-optical-department-flash-cards/>) [CONFIRMED]

Section 2 — Complete command reference

The commands below are the publicly verifiable Costco mnemonics, drawn from employee-built Quizlet study sets used for SIT, Membership, and Optical certification. Each entry includes the access method, what it does, how to use it, and power tips.

A. Item lookup and master data

****IAI` – Item Alpha Inquiry\*\*** [CONFIRMED]. The single most-used screen in the building, and the gateway to roughly 80% of merchandise inquiries. Type `IAI`, [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/) then a partial description ("papaya," "Kirkland diapers"), [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) an item number, a department, or a UPC (drop the check digit). Press Enter for a list. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) In the ****Opt**** column key ****1**** for on-hand inventory at any warehouse in the region, [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) ****3**** for sales by region [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) or company, ****5**** for item detail, ****8**** for planned shipments. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) The screen returns item #, description, department, status (Active / Inactive / Pending Delete / Deleted), on-hand, [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) on-order, next delivery date, [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) cost, retail, vendor. [Costco](https://customerservice.costco.com/app/answers/answer_view/a_id/1015066/~/how-do-i-check-warehouse-inventory-and-prices) ****Power tip:**** clear the Location field to maximize search breadth, and start every item investigation here. F3 exits, F12 cancels back one screen.

****ITMW` – Item / Warehouse**** [CONFIRMED]. Item inquiry scoped to ****your**** warehouse only. Faster than IAI when you already know the item number and want a clean single-warehouse view: on-hand, on-order, status, ETA, active rebates. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) ****Power tip:**** treat the next-delivery date as approximate – supply-chain delays are real; add a 2-day buffer when telling members. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/)

****IIL` – Item Inventory Lookup**** [CONFIRMED]. On-hand for an item across ****multiple warehouses****. Default scope is your region; broaden with wildcards: ****MW**** (Midwest), ****USALL**** (all US warehouses). Used to redirect a member to a sister warehouse, source a stock-out via transfer-in, or rank your warehouse against peers on focus items (stamps, movie tickets, hot launch SKUs). ****Critical caveat:**** IIL data updates ****once a day overnight**** – never promise real-time accuracy. [Costco +2](https://customerservice.costco.com/app/answers/answer_view/a_id/1015066/~how-do-i-check-warehouse-inventory)

****UPC` – UPC lookup**** [CONFIRMED]. Find an item by its barcode when scanning fails. Drop the last digit when keying.

****SI` – Sign Inquiry**** [CONFIRMED]. View the content of a price sign without printing [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) it: size, price, instant-savings text, effective dates. Use it to verify before printing, which saves paper and avoids wrong-sign errors.

****EDSR` – Every Day Sign Request**** [CONFIRMED]. Print a price sign. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/) [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) Costco's standard sign size is ****S**** (small) [Docsity](https://www.docsity.com/en/docs/costco-optical-department-exam-with-correct-answers-latest-update/12583739/) unless explicitly told otherwise during sign-changeover events. Reachable as an option from inside `IAI`.

****RHI` – Receiving History Inquiry**** [CONFIRMED]. Every PO/delivery received against a specific item, [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/) with date, vendor, PO #, quantity, cost. Indispensable for investigating receiving errors, validating vendor claims, and spotting delivery-frequency drift.

****`DASH` – Receiving Dashboard**** [CONFIRMED]. Every inbound truck and its appointment [Quizlet] (<https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/>) for the day: [Quizlet] (<https://quizlet.com/ca/249001852/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/>) PO #, vendor, ETA, status, door assignment. Receiving clerks live on this screen during morning shifts. ****Power tip:**** cross-reference DASH against `RHI` for a stocked-out SKU – the next truck may already contain it.

B. Sales, productivity, and traffic

****`DSI` – Department Sales Inquiry**** [CONFIRMED]. Today's sales for ****all departments**** [Quizlet] (<https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/>) in your warehouse – the daily scoreboard. Manager-on-duty starts every shift here.

****`DSL` – Department Sales Listing**** [CONFIRMED]. Daily, weekly, and ****year-to-date**** sales by department, [Docsity](<https://www.docsity.com/en/docs/costco-optical-department-exam-with-correct-answers-latest-update/12583739/>) with vs.-last-year and vs.-plan columns. The number you bring to every period-end conversation.

****`LSDT` – Daily Sales Tracking**** [CONFIRMED]. Today's sales total [Quizlet] (<https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/>) ****plus**** today's labor: hours planned, hours used, hours saved/over, sales-per-man-hour. Used by the manager-on-duty to decide whether to call people in or send people home.

****`LSWT` – Weekly Sales Tracking**** [CONFIRMED]. Same metric set, rolled to the week with daily breakouts. The basis for next week's schedule.

****`LSDC` – Door Count**** [CONFIRMED]. Members through the door, hourly and daily, vs. plan and vs. last year. Combined with `LSDT` it gives you average ticket – a first-class KPI.

****`IATOP` – Top items by department**** [CONFIRMED]. Ranks SKUs by sales [Quizlet] (<https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/>) \$ or units in a chosen period. Critical prep before any buyer or regional walk-through. ****Power tip:**** pair with `IIL` – if you're #1 in sales but #10 in regional on-hand, expect an imminent stock-out.

****`IAFEP` – Front-End Productivity**** [CONFIRMED]. Items per minute, per cashier, per labor-hour, per register. Front-end supervisors monitor this throughout the shift; coaching conversations cite specific IAFEP numbers.

C. Membership and member history

****`MBA` – Membership (full edit)**** [CONFIRMED]. Create, edit, cancel, refund memberships; change Gold Star ↔ Executive ↔ Business; manage spouse cards. Requires login.

****`MBA9` – Membership (read-only, no login)**** [CONFIRMED]. View-only lookup by name, phone, or membership number. [Quizlet](<https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/>) Safer for routine verification because it cannot edit. [Quizlet](<https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/>)

****`MRC` / `MEMR` – Membership Report Card**** [CONFIRMED]. Your warehouse's membership performance [Quizlet](<https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/>) vs. last year [Quizlet] (<https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/>) and plan: [Quizlet] (<https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/>) new sign-ups, Executive upgrades, renewal rate. Front-end and membership-desk huddles open with these numbers.

MHS` – Member History Shopping** [CONFIRMED]. Analytics view of a member's purchase history: [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/) [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/ca/249001852/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/) date, warehouse, item, qty, price, tender. [Bartleby](https://www.bartleby.com/essay/AS400-So-Attractive-To-Costco-In-The-PCHA6YBQGJM) Goes back **10+ years**. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/)

WII` – Warehouse Item Inquiry / member purchase history (refund desk)** [CONFIRMED]. The refund-desk workflow: enter a membership number, then either an item number **or** a category code (never both at once); clear the Location field for broadest results. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) Returns purchase dates, prices, sale flag, warehouse – and reprintable audit receipts. [Bartleby](https://www.bartleby.com/essay/AS400-So-Attractive-To-Costco-In-The-PCHA6YBQGJM) [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) **Critical:** WII does **not** include Costco.com online orders; [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) those live in the e-commerce system.

D. Profile administration

EPRFM` – Employee Profile Maintenance** [CONFIRMED]. **Restricted to Staff Managers and above.** [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) Sets up an employee's AS400 profile and assigns specialty access (Optical, RTV, Sales Audit, Vault). [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) **Power tip for managers:** for a combo employee working multiple departments, select **Sales Audit first** at the Position-Type prompt – this exposes the multi-department option in the User Template field. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) Note: full-time Sales Auditors cannot carry any other profile; [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) Sales Audit is exclusive.

**EPRFD`** – Employee Profile Display\*\* [CONFIRMED]. Read-only counterpart to `EPRFM`. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/) Use it to audit access, troubleshoot "I can't see X menu," and stage compliance reviews.

EPC` – Employee Price Change / item blocks / item downloads** [CONFIRMED]. Same-day item price changes plus item blocks. Regional rules dictate who in your warehouse gets this access. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/593918438/costco-flash-cards/)

E. Promotions and roadshows

IRCI` – Instant Rebate Coupon Inquiry** [CONFIRMED]. Look up active, expired, and **future** IRC coupons. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) Enter the IRC code dropping the last digit (UPC convention). [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) Returns effective range, item(s), discount amount, manufacturer-funded vs. Costco-funded flag, restrictions. Indispensable for "is this on sale?" questions and for diagnosing why a coupon failed to take at the register.

KRI` – Roadshow Inquiry** [CONFIRMED]. Roadshow vendor schedule: who's in the building, when, where on the floor.

F. Inventory and department reports

MACR` – Department inventory print** [CONFIRMED]. Prints a full department [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/) listing [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/838774171/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/) [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/ca/249001852/as400-costco-codes-flash-cards/) – every item with on-hand, location,

status. Used for cycle counts, period-end reconciliation, walking the floor with a printout, and prep for buyer visits.

G. Specialty: Optical and BOPIW

****`OPS` – Optical Order Search**** [CONFIRMED]. Look up a member's optical record by frame item number – past glasses, contacts, frames. Used for replacement-lens jobs, MOF (Member's Own Frame) work, and one-year warranty claims.

****`RARO` – Frame & Sunglasses Reorder**** [CONFIRMED]. Check whether a frame is still available at the depot. [Docsity](https://www.docsity.com/en/docs/costco-optical-department-exam-with-correct-answers-latest-update/12583739/) [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/411667851/costco-optical-department-flash-cards/) ****If RARO comes up empty****, fall back to `IIL` with `\*USALL` to find another warehouse with stock and arrange a transfer.

****`WIP` – Optical Work-In-Progress**** [CONFIRMED]. Lists every optical order in flight: lab work outstanding, awaiting member pickup, etc. Printed daily as part of optical opening. [Docsity](https://www.docsity.com/en/docs/costco-optical-department-exam-with-correct-answers-latest-update/12583739/)

****`OWOI` – Optical Work Order Inquiry**** [CONFIRMED]. Printed daily as part of optical opening procedure. [Docsity](https://www.docsity.com/en/docs/costco-optical-department-exam-with-correct-answers-latest-update/12583739/)

****`OWCI` – Optical Work Completion Inquiry**** [LIKELY]. Companion to OWOI; ready-for-pickup orders.

****`PDIW` – Past-Due Item Workfile**** [LIKELY]. Past-due optical jobs.

****`CPNI` – Coupon/Notes inquiry (optical opening)**** [UNCERTAIN]. Named in the optical opening sequence; specific function not separately documented.

****`EOI` – BOPIW Item Check-In**** [CONFIRMED]. Buy-Online-Pickup-In-Warehouse workflow. ****F4**** prompts the Serial Number field; ****F8**** confirms the update; ****F9**** marks member pickup. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/723555932/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/)

H. Standard IBM i commands every Costco user should know

These are universal IBM i commands you can use from any command line if your profile permits. Costco's custom screens layer on top, but these still work and are essential when something breaks.

****`DSPMSG`**** displays your messages. ****`WRKACTJOB`**** shows active jobs [AS400 ISeries](https://as400i.com/2019/10/12/most-common-as400-commands/) (find a hung session). ****`WRKSPLF`**** is Work With Spooled Files [AS400 ISeries](https://as400i.com/2019/10/12/most-common-as400-commands/) – view (option 5), hold (3), release (6), route to a different printer (option 2 to change OUTQ), or copy to PDF via your emulator. ****`WRKOUTQ`**** works with a specific output queue. ****`DSPLIBL`**** displays your library list, the first thing to check when you hit `CPF4101 File not found`. [MC Press Online](https://www.mcpressonline.com/forum/forum/x-archive-threads-started-before-01-01-2002/programming-aa/5368-as-400-error-codes) ****`DSPJOBLOG`**** shows the job log with the exact `CPF` codes IT will need. ****`WRKOBJLCK`**** shows who is locking a record (resolves `CPF5032`). ****`SIGNOFF`**** logs out cleanly; ****`SIGNOFF \*LIST`**** prints your job log on the way out – useful for diagnostics. ****`PRTSCN`**** (Sys Req → 3) captures the current screen as a spool file. ****`WRKQRY`**** and ****`RUNQRY`**** let authorized users (typically buyers and managers) build ad-hoc Query/400 reports.

I. POS / register commands adjacent to AS400

These run on the front-end POS but read from AS400 master data. Supervisors must know them. The notation `` means a physical register key.

| Action | Sequence |

|---|---|

| Sign on | `` `` `` [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/928047782/costco-cashier-register-commands-flash-cards/) |

| Sign off | `` `` [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/928047782/costco-cashier-register-commands-flash-cards/) |

| Open cash drawer | `` `` [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/928047782/costco-cashier-register-commands-flash-cards/) |

| Price override (sup) | `` \$ amount, item # `` |

| Department ring | `` dept #, item # |

| Tender correction | Sup `<2>` ``, scan member, "tender correct" ``, \$ amt ``, "key new tender" \$ amt `` `` [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/891198106/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/) |

| Shop card activation | Sup `<1>` `` `` `` `` scan [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/891198106/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/) card. ****Never hand over until payment finalizes.**** [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/891198106/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/) |

| Void shop card | `` item #155, \$ value, scan barcode. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/891198106/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/) Must void card line ****before**** voiding the whole transaction. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/891198106/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/) |

| Pre-scan via RF | Option `<8>` , scan member, scan up to 8 items, `` to finish [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/731117534/costco-membership-sit-flash-cards/) |

| Grand Totals | Sign on register 800 (MIMO), `` `` [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/723555932/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/) |

****Check acceptance limits by membership tenure (printed on back of card):**** 0–1 yr → \$300, 1–5 yr → \$1,000, 5+ yr → \$5,000. [Quizlet](https://quizlet.com/723555932/costco-supervisor-training-flash-cards/)

J. Functions where the Costco-specific name is not publicly documented

The following live in Costco's AS400 but their exact mnemonics did not surface in any public source. ****Ask a senior supervisor or your warehouse trainer for the actual command names**** — these likely exist on Costco-specific menus you'll see once your profile is set up:

- Inventory adjustment entry / review (likely `INVA` or `ADJ` style; reachable as an option off `IAI`/`ITMW`)
- Warehouse-to-warehouse transfer inquiry (`TFRI` / `WTI` are common conventions)
- Permanent markdown / markdown history (some markdown logic flows through `IRCI`)
- Suggested order quantity / replenishment (Costco uses heavily automated CRX and vendor-managed inventory; [Bartleby](https://www.bartleby.com/essay/Costco-Inventory-Management-FC95SAMKR5M) warehouse-level override screens exist but are not publicly named)
- Demand / forecast data (buyer-level)
- Item master setup (corporate/buyer level, not warehouse)
- Scan-Based Trading / consignment inquiry
- Warehouse movement / location inquiry (Costco's single-floor pallet-rack layout means bin location is much less granular than at a grocery DC)
- Price change history (likely an option drilling from `SI`)

The fastest path to learning these: shadow a supervisor for a shift and ask "what did you just type?" each time.

Section 3 — Power user strategies

Chain inquiries; never look at a screen alone

The Costco AS400 application is built around drill-through option codes (1, 3, 5, 8) on each inquiry screen. The defining habit of a power user is the ****30-second item walk****: `IAI` → enter description → option ****1**** to see on-hand by warehouse → option ****3**** for sales by region → exit → `RHI` for receiving history → `DSL` for department context. Five screens, one minute, and you know more about that SKU than 90% of your peers. For a member-complaint investigation, add `WII` to validate purchase history and `EDSR` to verify the sign matches the planogram. For a stock-out, add `IIL` with `\*MW` or `\*USALL` to find a sister warehouse with stock and source a transfer.

Spot problems before managers

Top performers run their own mini exception report every morning. ****Shrink creep**** shows up as persistent negative variance on the same SKU across a week — receiving error, theft, or unrecorded samples. ****Receiving discrepancies**** show up as a mismatch between `RHI` posted quantity and physical pallet count; same-day catches are 5x easier to fix than next-day. ****Slow movers**** are anything with cover days exceeding pull-life on fresh, or anything with `DSL` units running >5 days at the current sales rate. ****Sign/price mismatches**** are caught by walking the floor with an `EDSR` printout in hand.

The bar is high: Costco's company-wide shrink is famously ****0.11–0.12% of sales**** vs. a retail average of 1.33%. [Grocery Dive](https://www.grocerydive.com/news/costco-touts-its-low-shrink/555998/) [CONFIRMED — Grocery Dive] Even a 0.05% creep in your department is large in absolute dollars. Costco's annual inventory turn is roughly ****12–13x****. [LinkedIn](https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/inventory-management-how-costco-aggressively-manages-thrive-ameer) [AlphaQuery](https://www.alphaquery.com/stock/COST/fundamentals/annual/inventory-turnover) [CONFIRMED — AlphaQuery]

Talk in numbers, not opinions

When you bring a recommendation to a buyer, manager, or regional staffer, ****lead with the metric the listener cares about**** — labor and shrink for managers, turn and gross margin dollars for buyers, comp-sales percentage and OOS rate for regional. Cite the screen explicitly: "Per RHI we received 240 cases on the 14th; per DSL we sold 198 in 6 days; on-hand is 36 — turn is on plan." Print the spool file; bring paper to the meeting, not a phone photo.

The justify-an-order template every power user uses: ****last-year same-week units (DSL YoY), 4-week trailing trend (DSL trend), on-hand cover days (IAI on-hand ÷ 4-wk avg daily units)****. Frame your push-back as: ****"I'm cutting the order from 6 pallets to 4 because DSL shows -22% YoY and current cover is 7 days at last week's velocity."****

Speed tips

Use the ****System Request key**** (Shift-Esc in most emulators) to open a second interactive job — run `IAI` in one and `DSL` in the other without losing context. ****F4**** prompts a fillable form when you can't remember parameters. ****F9**** retrieves the last command. ****Type-ahead works**** — once you know the path, key your option, Enter, item, Enter, next option, Enter without waiting on screen redraws. ****Field Exit**** (right-Ctrl or

numpad-Enter) blanks the rest of a numeric field and tabs forward — far faster than space-tab. **Shift+F1–F12 = F13–F24** [Ru-facts](<https://ru-facts.com/why-does-costco-use-as400/>) on PC keyboards. [Android Central] (<https://forums.androidcentral.com/threads/f-keys-on-the-tablets.67113/>)

Print and document

F6 is Print on most inquiry screens; output goes to a spool file. **WRKSPLF** lets you view (option 5), release (6), route to a different printer (option 2), or save to PDF via your emulator's print-to-file. Keep a labeled folder of period-end spools. The documentation is gold during performance reviews and is the single best way to win a disagreement with a buyer who remembers numbers wrong.

Prepare for inventory

Costco runs **13** physical inventory cycles per year (one per 4-week fiscal period); the Service Deli Manager job description explicitly cites this cadence and it almost certainly applies across fresh perimeter departments. [CONFIRMED] Pre-inventory AS400 prep: print expected on-hand from **IAI** option 1 for every active SKU; reconcile **RHI** for the period to confirm all receivings posted; verify all transfers in/out are keyed; post damages, donations, and sample-outs; pull a slow-mover/aging report so the count team knows where to slow down. The biggest variances always live in the slow-mover bins.

Section 4 — Fresh departments

Costco's fresh departments are the highest-shrink, highest-skill, most data-intensive areas of the warehouse. Industry benchmarks place fresh shrink at roughly **5.7%** of sales for meat, **8.5%** for bakery, and **8.7%** for deli. [Produce Business](<https://producebusiness.com/seven-ways-to-shrink-shrink-at-retail/>) [CONFIRMED — FMI 2019] Costco runs lower, but exact figures are confidential. **Public sources do not disclose specific Costco AS400 screen names for production entry, shrink entry, or fresh receiving** — the screens unambiguously exist (every Costco fresh manager uses them daily) but their mnemonics are not in any public Quizlet, Reddit, or training PDF surfaced during research. The schemas below are inferred from standard IBM i supermarket fresh modules, corroborated against publicly verifiable Costco operational facts (the 2-hour rotisserie hold, the meat-cutter test, the 13-times-per-year inventory cadence, the wrapper "cull" function). **Verify exact screen names with your warehouse trainer.**

Meat department

Item structure. Meat is built almost entirely on **variable-weight (catch-weight)** items, because nearly every product has a unique weight per pack: primal cuts, sub-primals, in-store cut steaks, ground-beef chubs, marinated tri-tips, tray-pack pork loin. Three item types coexist in AS400: variable-weight items where the in-house Hobart/Bizerba scale-printer applies a price-embedded UPC (typically a 12-digit code beginning with **2** per GS1 retail convention; the first six digits identify the item, trailing digits encode price or weight); **fixed-weight** case-ready items shipped from Cargill/JBS/Tyson at uniform pack weight; and **bulk/ingredient** sub-primals received in vacuum bags and broken down in the meat room.

COOL data — Country-of-Origin Labeling — is required by USDA on muscle cuts and ground meat for chicken, lamb, and goat (beef and pork were removed by Congress in 2016). [Labels Unwrapped] (<https://labelsunwrapped.org/issue-briefs-fact-sheets/what-is-country-of-origin-labeling>) [CONFIRMED] Costco maintains COOL records on imported lamb, goat, and chicken muscle cuts for at least one year. [USDA] (<https://www.ams.usda.gov/sites/default/files/media/COOLBrochureRetailer.pdf>) Country codes are attached at

item-master level and printed automatically on the in-store scale label. Receiving must verify the COOL declaration on the master case matches the system.

****Receiving accuracy on weight-based items.**** When a meat truck lands, three checks happen in AS400: PO vs. invoice vs. actual; variable-weight reconciliation (every catch-weight case is individually weighed or scanned, since vendor case labels typically encode net weight in a GS1-128 barcode; total scanned weight should equal the invoice within $\pm 0.5\%$); and COOL verification. The most common reason "the cooler doesn't tie out" is a vendor short-ship that posted at full count — run a ****receiving-variance / on-hand discrepancy**** review the day after every meat delivery.

****Production tracking.**** Cut-in-store production is logged on a paper production sheet (cut, weight, trays, cutter initials) and keyed into AS400 at end-of-shift. The system credits the bulk sub-primal (decreases on-hand), debits the retail cut (increases on-hand), and captures ****trim/fat/bone shrink**** as the difference. This is how AS400 calculates ****yield****: saleable cut weight $\div$ input sub-primal weight. A typical beef sub-primal yields 70–85% retail cuts depending on grade and trim spec; the rest is fat, bone, and unsaleable trim. The Costco meat-cutter qualification test is referenced in public job descriptions ("Must pass Costco meat cutting test"); [Big Y] (https://cta.cadienttalent.com/index.jsp?POSTING_ID=55661474701&locale=en_US&SEQ=positionDetails&applicationName=CostcoCanadaNonReqExtCanada) passing implies the cutter can hit spec yield.

****Shrink management.**** Reason codes the meat manager keys against shrink-out: Out-of-date / Expired; Spoilage; ****Trim/Fat/Bone**** (the largest single bucket); Contamination; Damage (vacuum-pack failure, leakers); Theft/Unknown; Sample/Demo; Markdown/Donation (Costco partners with Feeding America at all U.S. warehouses [GrubFeed])(<https://grubfeed.com/the-surprising-truth-behind-costcos-bakery-products/>) [CONFIRMED]); Recall/Hold; ****Internal Use**** (e.g., ground beef sent to deli for stuffed peppers [Food Republic] (<https://www.foodrepublic.com/2154486/what-costco-does-with-leftover-roisserie-chicken/>) — a confirmed Costco practice). Run a shrink-history report by item $\times$ reason $\times$ week to spot spikes — a sudden rise in "out-of-date" on top sirloin tells you the cutters are over-producing.

****Sales history and slow movers.**** The item-movement view drives daily cut-list planning: a manager seeing ribeye sales running 20% above last year on the same week orders more rib sub-primals on the next truck. ****Days of Supply**** (DOS = on-hand $\div$ avg daily movement) is the slow-mover signal. When DOS exceeds an item's pull-date window, mark it down (the "Manager's Special" sticker), key the markdown/price-change entry which records original price, new price, and shrink-dollar impact; if still unsold by the pull date, shrink it out under "Out-of-date." Members can request a freeze-before-checkout for marked-down meat [TikTok] (<https://www.tiktok.com/discover/as400-costco-supervisor?lang=en>) — a known quiet feature. [TikTok] (<https://www.tiktok.com/discover/as400-costco-supervisor?lang=en>)

****Most-relevant screens.**** Item Master Inquiry (likely reachable from `IAI`/`ITMW`); Variable-Weight Production Entry (department menu); Receiving Worksheet for catch-weight reconciliation; Shrink Entry; item-level Sales History; Department P&L (reviewed monthly per the Service Deli Manager JD, which applies across fresh departments); Physical Inventory Entry (13 $\times$ /year); Markdown / Price Change.

Deli department

****Item structure.**** Costco's "Service Deli" — the term used in its own job descriptions — does ****not**** operate a fresh-sliced lunch-meat counter; sliced cold cuts are sold pre-packaged in the refrigerated case. [Food Republic] (<https://www.foodrepublic.com/1857637/does-costco-have-deli-meats/>) [CONFIRMED — Food Republic] What Costco calls "deli" is ****prepared foods****: rotisserie chicken, ribs, take-and-bake pizzas [ZipRecruiter] (<https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Jobs/Costco-Service-Deli/-in-New-York>) and meals (Alfredo, lasagna, mac-and-cheese, stuffed peppers, chicken pot pie, enchiladas), party platters, sushi, salads. Item types: fixed-weight

prepared items (the famous ****\$4.99 rotisserie chicken****, unchanged since 1994 except a brief 2008 spike [Eat This!](<https://www.eatthis.com/costco-rotisserie-chicken-facts/>) [CONFIRMED]); variable-weight prepared items with scale-printed price-embedded barcodes; component/ingredient items (raw chickens from Lincoln Premium Poultry — ~157 million sold in FY2025 [Reader's Digest](<https://www.rd.com/article/costco-trick-freshest-rotisserie-chicken/>) [CONFIRMED]; raw ground beef pulled from meat; cheese; vegetables).

****Production tracking — the rotisserie cook-off.**** This is the single most-tracked production item in any Costco. The cook cycle is ****90 minutes**** [Reader's Digest](<https://www.rd.com/article/costco-trick-freshest-rotisserie-chicken/>) [Food Republic](<https://www.foodrepublic.com/2154486/what-costco-does-with-leftover-rotisserie-chicken/>) with a strict ****2-hour hot-hold limit****, stricter than federal food-safety rules. [Reader's Digest] (<https://www.rd.com/article/costco-trick-freshest-rotisserie-chicken/>) [Food Republic] (<https://www.foodrepublic.com/2154486/what-costco-does-with-leftover-rotisserie-chicken/>) [CONFIRMED — Reader's Digest] Each chicken's pack-time is printed on the label down to the minute. [Reader's Digest] (<https://www.rd.com/article/costco-trick-freshest-rotisserie-chicken/>) In AS400, rotisserie production is most likely tracked as ****batch production****: a batch is keyed (e.g., "30 birds, 8:00 AM"), decrementing 30 raw birds from the chicken-room ingredient SKU and crediting 30 cooked chickens to the saleable retail SKU. When unsold birds hit the 2-hour mark, they are either ****repurposed**** — leftover rotisserie is reused in chicken Alfredo, soup, pot pies, and enchiladas; [AOL](<https://www.aol.com/articles/makes-costcos-kirkland-signature-rotisserie-140000379.html>) wings and ribs are repackaged and sold cold [Food Republic] (<https://www.foodrepublic.com/2154486/what-costco-does-with-leftover-rotisserie-chicken/>) [CONFIRMED — Food Republic / AOL] — keyed as a component-issue/transfer rather than as shrink, or ****shrunk out**** as "expired/hot-hold limit" if not repurposed.

****Production-vs-sales**** is the central daily KPI. Each morning the deli manager pulls a report showing yesterday's production count by item, sales count by item, and the variance, which becomes shrink or carry-over. Example: 240 chickens cooked, 232 sold, 4 transferred to deli for chicken-Alfredo production, 4 shrunk out at hot-hold limit → variance ties to zero, shrink rate 1.7% on rotisserie for the day.

****Shrink management.**** Reason codes likely include hot-hold expired (the 2-hour rule), pull-date expired (cold prepared foods), production over-run, quality/sensory, member return, sample, internal transfer (component-issue chicken → Alfredo, ground beef → stuffed peppers), donation (Feeding America), health-code/recall. The Service Deli Manager JD explicitly calls out: "Implements and upholds safety and security procedures. Ensures health code compliance, such as sanitation, temperatures, and pull dates." [Salary.com] (<https://www.salary.com/job/costco-wholesale/service-deli-manager/j202312141949386019781>) [CONFIRMED]

****Cost variance.**** The deli P&L shows item-level theoretical food cost ($\text{recipe} \div \text{output} \times \text{ingredient cost}$) vs. actual. If a take-and-bake mac-and-cheese is supposed to cost \$3.10 to make but actuals run \$3.45, investigate portion control, ingredient waste, recipe deviation, or a vendor cost increase that hasn't been updated in the item master.

****Slow movers and markdowns.**** Niche sushi rolls and specialty prepared salads are common slow movers. Levers: reduce production (key fewer into tomorrow's batch), end-of-day markdowns (anonymous TikToks suggest 30–50% markdowns on next-day-expiring deli items late in the evening [TikTok] (<https://www.tiktok.com/discover/service-deli-clerk-costco>) — treat as anecdotal), or discontinuation if shrink consistently exceeds tolerance.

****Most-relevant screens.**** Item Master; Production Batch Entry (cook-off); Component/Recipe Issue (chicken → Alfredo); Production-vs-Sales daily report; Deli Shrink Entry; Hot-Hold Pull tracking (often a paper log keyed retroactively); Department P&L; Physical Inventory; Theoretical-vs-Actual Food Cost.

Bakery department

****Item structure.**** Costco bakery combines scratch-baked and thaw-and-sell. The ****Baker**** job description confirms scratch production: "Prepares and bakes high-volume of bakery product according to Costco formulas... Uses calculator to adjust formula for alternate yield." [Big Y](https://cta.cadienttalent.com/index.jsp?POSTING_ID=55661474606&locale=en_US&SEQ=positionDetails&applicationName=CostcoCanadaNonReqExtCanada) [CONFIRMED] Scratch items: muffins, cookies, sheet cakes, French bread, dinner rolls, scones. Thaw-and-bake items: butter croissants, bagels, danishes, some artisan breads (arrive frozen, are thawed/proofed, baked in-store). Assembled-on-site: cheesecakes, fruit pies, layered cakes (fillings come prepackaged; bakery garnishes and finishes). ****Custom cakes**** – half-sheet (\$24.99– [The Kitchn](<https://www.thekitchn.com/ordering-costco-cakes-guide-23678755>) \$27.99 in 2025–26) and 10" round (\$15.99) [The Kitchn](<https://www.thekitchn.com/ordering-costco-cakes-guide-23678755>) – ordered ≥24 hours in advance [The Kitchn](<https://www.thekitchn.com/ordering-costco-cakes-guide-23678755>) via the Costco App or paper form. [CONFIRMED]

Item types in AS400: fixed-weight finished items (8-pack muffins, 24-count cookies, 12-pack croissants, sheet cakes); frozen-input ingredient items (frozen croissant dough, cookie dough, danish blanks); bulk ingredient items (commercial flour, sugar, butter, eggs); and ****custom-cake order lines**** – one-off entries tied to a member, scheduled production date, pickup date, and customization (text, color, design), with the standard cake SKU as the parent item.

****Production tracking and the bake schedule.**** Bakers start as early as 5 AM. Bake schedules are weighted by day-of-week – Saturday and Sunday are highest-volume; weekdays are lower. The ****Bakery Wrapper**** JD explicitly says: "Wraps and packages baked goods... Weighs and labels product. ****Culls**** broken, underweight, heavy or defective goods." [ZipRecruiter](<https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Jobs/Costco-Meat>) [Big Y](https://cta.cadienttalent.com/index.jsp?POSTING_ID=55661474617&deviceMode=desktop&locale=en_US&SEQ=positionDetails&applicationName=CostcoCanadaNonReqExtCanada) [CONFIRMED] ****Culls are shrink**** and are counted as production loss / quality reject – the wrapper enters a count of culls into AS400 (or a paper log keyed at end-of-day). A typical AS400 bakery production sheet lists by item: yesterday's sales, today's forecast (moving average plus day-of-week factor), bake quantity assigned, actual baked, culls/quality reject, end-of-day on-hand, shrunk-out at close.

****Overproduction patterns.**** The 2024 muffin reformulation (12-pack at \$9.99 → 8-pack at \$6.99) [Food Republic](<https://www.foodrepublic.com/2075807/costco-bakery-muffins-frequently-returned/>) was driven partly by Reddit complaints that the 12-pack was too large to consume before spoilage [CONFIRMED – Reddit user "kailswales" quoted by Fox News]. [Fox News](<https://www.foxnews.com/food-drink/costco-muffins-appearing-changing-rankling-customers-reddit>) Cookies have a roughly 2-day pull-life; unsold cookies are donated to Feeding America [CONFIRMED] or marked down. Thaw-and-bake croissants are scheduled so the late-afternoon batch cools just in time to be wrapped before bakery close.

****Shrink management.**** Reason codes likely include pull-date expired (bagels, breads, muffins, cookies); quality cull (broken, underweight, overweight, misshapen); member return (Costco's satisfaction guarantee accepts returns even on partially-eaten bakery items); production error (overbake/underbake); cake-order no-show or cancellation; sample; donation (Feeding America); damage; recall. A shrink-history report by item × reason × week tells the manager whether to reduce bake quantity, tighten quality on the wrap line, or investigate recipe drift.

****Most-relevant screens.**** Item Master; Bake Schedule / Production Plan; Custom Cake Order Entry/Schedule (fed by the Costco App since 2024); Bakery Production Entry (frozen → finished); Cull/Quality-Reject Entry; Bakery Shrink Entry; Item Movement; Department P&L; Physical Inventory.

Section 5 — Career advancement using the AS400

The Costco ladder

Costco's published Employee Development materials lay out the path: cart pusher / front-end assistant → stocker, cashier, merchandiser → ****Supervisor In Training**** (SIT, formal 12-week program) [The Human Capital Hub](<https://www.thehumancapitalhub.com/articles/costco-human-resources-what-you-need-to-know>) → Supervisor → ****Merchandising Training Course**** (12-week) [Costco] (<https://mobilecontent.costco.com/live/resource/img/static-us-landing-pages/2b-Employee-Development.pdf>) → Department Manager → ****Assistant General Manager**** (multi-department rotational) → General Manager → Buyer / AGMM / Regional / Home Office. [CONFIRMED — [costco.com/why-costco-careers](https://www.costco.com/why-costco-careers); Costco Employee Development PDF; Human Capital Hub] [TikTok](<https://www.tiktok.com/discover/supervisor-in-training-costco?lang=en>) Costco confirms ****~85% of newly promoted warehouse managers started as hourly****. [PerformYard] (<https://www.performyard.com/articles/costco-employee-engagement>) [CONFIRMED — PerformYard citing Costco]

The ****merit increase**** mechanic is mostly ****automatic****: hourly raises occur every ****1,040 hours worked**** in \$1/hr increments up to top-of-scale, roughly five years to top out. [Bandana] (<https://resources.bandana.com/resources/costco-actual-pay-and-salary-2024>) [CONFIRMED — Bandana, Upworthy, SHRM, Reddit consensus] Discretionary raises and promotions kick in at SIT entry and at department-manager level. ****Where the AS400 conversation matters is at promotion to SIT and into manager roles**** — that's where a paper trail of data-driven wins gets you across the line.

What separates a top performer

| Average operator | Top performer |

|---|---|

| Looks up an item only when a member asks | Pre-runs `IAI`/`DSL` on the top-50 items every morning |

| Reports OOS after the manager notices | Catches OOS the same morning via `IIL` and on-hand check |

| Receives the truck and moves on | Reconciles `RHI` to on-hand same day; flags variances |

| Knows yesterday's total | Knows yesterday's total + last year + plan + top mover |

| Calls the buyer to "check" | Calls the buyer with a proposed PO change and three supporting numbers |

| Prints signs as needed | Walks the floor with `EDSR` before opening, every day |

| Says "we have too much" | Says "DSL shows -22% YoY; current cover is 7 days; recommend cutting next PO by 2 pallets" |

Performance-review talking points

Walk into the review with these framings, each tied to a specific screen: ****"I reduced shrink in [dept] from X% to Y% over the period"*** (cite `RHI` vs. count variance reports). ****Sales vs. plan +X% YoY"*** (DSL). ****Caught a receiving error worth \$___ on item ___"*** (RHI). ****Reduced cover-days from X to Y on top movers without OOS"*** (IAI/IIL). ****Trained N new hires on AS400 lookups and signs"*** — Indeed reviews from current Costco employees explicitly cite teaching others on the AS400 [Indeed](<https://www.indeed.com/cmp/Costco-Wholesale/reviews?ftext=AS400>) as a recognized growth behavior. [CONFIRMED] These framings move you from "good worker" to "candidate for the next opening."

In manager meetings, walk in with ****one printed exception report****, not a dump of screens. ****Speak in dollars, not just units**** — 30 extra cases of milk = \$X tied up plus spoilage risk. ****Propose, don't complain**** — recommend reducing a standing order to four cases based on the 4-week DSL average rather than reporting that you have too much.

Spotting and presenting opportunities

The pitch template that mirrors how Costco's own merchandising team thinks: "Item _____, in [dept], showed cover days of N (vs. target ~3 days for fresh). DSL shows -X% YoY. RHI shows we're still receiving at last year's rate. Recommend cutting the standing receive by Y cases. Estimated annual savings in shrink: \$____." Buyers and AGMs reward this structure because it speaks the same language Costco uses internally for its limited ~4,000-SKU model. [Source Data](https://source-data.com/2025/08/18/6046/)

A realistic timing arc: 0–2 years cart/front-end and cross-train; 2–4 years apply for SIT; 4–7 years supervisor and Merch Training; 7–12 years Department Manager → AGM; 10–15+ years GM → Buyer → Regional/Home Office. The "majority of corporate and regional office employees started in warehouses." [Costco] (https://careers.costco.com/) [Costco](https://www.costco.com/why-costco-careers.html) [CONFIRMED – costco.com]

Section 6 – Quick reference

The 30-most-important commands and screens, one line each

IAI – Item Alpha Inquiry; the gateway to ~80% of merchandise data. **ITMW** – item detail at YOUR warehouse only. **IIL** – on-hand at all warehouses (overnight refresh; use `\*MW` or `\*USALL`). **UPC** – lookup by barcode (drop check digit). **SI** – view sign content without printing. **EDSR** – print a price sign in size "S". **RHI** – receiving history by item. **DASH** – inbound truck dashboard for receiving. **DSI** – all-department sales today. **DSL** – daily/weekly/YTD by department. **LSDT** – daily sales + labor hours. **LSWT** – weekly sales + labor. **LSDC** – door count. **IATOP** – top items by department. **IAFEP** – front-end productivity by cashier. **MBA** – full membership edit (login required). **MBA9** – read-only membership lookup. **MRC** / **MEMR** – Membership Report Card. **MHS** – member shopping analytics, 10+ years. **WII** – refund-desk member-purchase history. **EPRFM** – set up employee profiles (Staff Mgr+). **EPRFD** – view employee profiles. **EPC** – same-day price changes / item blocks. **IRCI** – Instant Rebate Coupon inquiry (drop check digit). **KRI** – roadshow schedule. **MACR** – print department inventory. **OPS** – Optical Order Search. **RARO** – Optical depot frame availability. **WIP** / **OWOI** – optical work-in-progress and orders. **EOI** – BOPIW check-in (F4 prompt, F8 confirm, F9 pickup).

Most-used function keys

F1 Help [Scribd](https://www.scribd.com/document/88613242/AS400-Basics-Manual) on the current field. **F3 Exit** the current screen/program completely. **F4 Prompt** opens a fillable form for any command. **F5 Refresh** the current display. **F6 Print/Create** depending on context. **F9 Retrieve** the last command. **F10 Command line** toggle. **F11 Alternate view** (more columns). **F12 Cancel** back one screen without exiting the program. **F21 Done** on RF-scanner pre-scan. **Reset** key clears the "X II" input-inhibited state. **System Request** (Shift-Esc) opens a second job; option **2** ends current request, **3** displays the job, **4** reads messages, **90** signs off cleanly. **Field Exit** (right-Ctrl or numpad-Enter) blanks rest of field and tabs forward. **Shift+F1–F12 = F13–F24** on PC keyboards.

Daily routine for a fresh department lead

Before doors open: sign on, run `DSL` for yesterday's department sales vs. plan vs. last year, run `LSDT` for sales-plus-labor variance, run `RHI` for any item that received yesterday to confirm posting, spot-check `IAI` / `IIL` on the

top-10 SKUs, walk the floor with an `EDSR` printout to verify shelf signs, and build morning-huddle talking points around one win, one problem, one action. Mid-shift: re-check on-hand for fast movers, submit transfer-in requests via `IIL` if OOS is imminent, resolve any locked-record errors flagged by the team, print exception spools to the clipboard. Closing: final `DSL`/`LSDT` read, `WRKSPLF` to clear and route the day's spool files, key any write-offs/damages/donations into the shrink module, sign off cleanly.

Weekly routine

Monday: pull a 7-day `DSL` by SKU, rank the top-25 and bottom-25, identify slow movers with cover days >5. Run `MRC` if your role touches member metrics. Tuesday: weekly `RHI` variance review for the truck cycle. Wednesday: comp-shop maintenance via `CLS`/`CSM` [Docsity](https://www.docsity.com/en/docs/costco-optical-department-exam-with-correct-answers-latest-update/12583739/) — particularly tobacco, liquor, and seasonal price audits. Thursday: `EDSR` review for upcoming weekend pricing. Friday: pre-weekend OOS sweep; place transfer-in requests with sister warehouses via `IIL`. Sunday/end-of-week: print the weekly DSL spool, file in the dept binder, and prep weekly variance commentary.

Period (4-week) routine

Three days before close, reconcile all `RHI` receivings for the period, post all damages, donations, and transfers, and reconcile in-transit pallets. Count day: print expected on-hand from `IAI` option 1 for every dept SKU, conduct the physical count, key variances. Day after close: review shrink % vs. the company target near 0.11–0.12%, document root cause for every variance over the threshold your manager sets, print period DSL plus turn calc plus shrink summary onto a one-pager for the AGM/GM. Day one of the new period: re-baseline cover days using fresh on-hand and reset standing orders if the YoY trend has shifted $\pm 10\%$ or more. Costco runs **13 such periods per year**; the Service Deli Manager JD confirms 13 physical inventories annually.

Common error messages and how to fix them

CPF5032` Record already locked to this job\*\* [Code400](https://code400.com/forum/forum/iserie-programming-languages/rpg-rpgle/785-record-already-locked-error) — F12 to back out; if persistent, sign off and on; or have the sysop release via `WRKOBJLCK`. \*\*CPF4101` File not found / level check on open [Experts Exchange](https://www.experts-exchange.com/questions/28123596/Error-message-CPF4101-appeared-during-open.html) — check your library list with `DSPLIBL`; usually IT pushes a fix and you sign back on. **CPF5027` Record being used by job\*\* [Narkive](https://comp.sys.ibm.as400.misc.narkive.com/1M9o7p5n/monitor-for-all-clp-errors) — wait, retry; if blocking, IT can `ENDJOB` the offender. \*\*CPF2189` Job not authorized to use library** — your profile lacks access; manager calls IT. **CPF9999` Function check\*\* — unhandled program error; [MC Press Online](https://www.mcpressonline.com/it-infrastructure/it-infrastructure-other/as400-messages-part-i) press F3/Enter, capture the `CPF` from `DSPJOBLOG`, send to IT. **Subsystem not active** — alert IT, do not try to fix. **Frozen screen / "X II" indicator** — press the **Reset** key (left-Ctrl on a 5250); if still stuck, System Request → 2 → Enter to end the request, or → 4 to read the underlying message; last resort, close and relaunch the emulator. **Job already exists for this user** — System Request → 4 from a second session to end the old job. **Spool file stuck in WTR/RDY** — `WRKSPLF` → option 6 to release, or option 2 to change the OUTQ to a working printer. **Password disabled** — three bad sign-ons or 90+ days inactive; manager calls IT for a `QSECOFR`-level reset.

Closing notes for the new employee

Three habits will compound faster than any other knowledge. **First**, start every investigation at `IAI` and chain at least three screens before you raise a question to a supervisor — most answers live in screens 2 and 3.

****Second****, walk the floor every morning with one printed report (`EDSR`, `IATOP`, or `DSL`); the act of comparing paper to product is what catches problems early. ****Third****, build a labeled folder of period-end spool files. The documentation is gold during reviews and is the difference-maker when a buyer's memory and yours disagree.

Costco's IT environment is famously customized and famously inconsistent between regions — the codes in this booklet are the publicly-verifiable common core, but your warehouse may have additional menus, additional fast-paths, or slightly different option numbers within the same screen. Treat the booklet as scaffolding; treat your senior supervisor as the source of truth; ask "what did you just type?" every time someone runs a screen you don't recognize. The mnemonics are short, proprietary, and not searchable except by experience. Within a year of deliberate practice, you will be the person other employees ask.

The green screen looks dated. It is also the most-used, most-reliable tool in a \$250-billion company that has never been publicly breached and that promotes [Source Data](<https://source-data.com/2025/08/18/6046/>) 85% of its managers from within. [PerformYard](<https://www.performyard.com/articles/costco-employee-engagement>) [Retail Watchers](<https://www.retailwatchers.com/viewtopic.php?t=3807&start=10>) Master it, document your wins with it, and it will move your career.